

Lecture 14

Unit 4 How to Make Refutations

What is a Refutation

A refutation attempts to point out problems with opposing view and to show where an opponent's argument breaks down.

- the counterclaim
- our position
- our refutation

Why to refute

- To get readers to listen to our perspective.
- To make ourselves more believable.
- To understand our own arguments better.

How to refute

- Point out the counterargument's limits by putting the opposing view in a larger context.
- Tell the other side of the story.
- Address logical fallacies in the counterargument.

How to signal a refutation

Thinking of the opposing position

It (has been/may be/could be)

- argued/asserted/claimed/said that
- contended/maintained that

Unit 8 How to Write with cohesion and coherence

What is cohesion and coherence

cohesion:

the degree to which sentences or paragraphs are connected so that the flow of ideas is easy to follow(at the language level)

coherence:

the overall understandability of what we write or say.(at the logic level)

For Cohesion

Grammatical

- reference:
determiners, pronouns, comparative words
- substitution:
elements using the ones, the same, so, no, do/does/did, etc.
- ellipsis
omission of words
- conjunction
the use of transitional words or phrases that link sentences and paragraphs smoothly.

Lexical

- Reiteration
words families, synonyms and antonyms
hyponyms and superordinate
- collocation
lexical chains

For Coherence

Rhetorical

- parallelism

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1. because
2. but
3. In fact
4. Instead(different to former)
5. Indeed(identical to former)
6. For this reason
7. The fact that
8. especially
9. needless to say

10. because